

satellite broadcast with a total TV audience of 79 million TV households currently.

The Indian cable and satellite industry is one of the fastest growing industries in the world. Currently, there are about 250 channels being transmitted over Indian skies with more than 100 channels originating from Indian shores. The major Broadcasters include Doordarshan, Zee, Star, Sony, Sun TV, ESPN - Star Sports. Other prominent broadcasters are ETC, ETV, Turner and Discovery. Currently there are multiple pay-channels and some are even free to air channels.

However, most of the operators have one-way 450/550 MHz networks capable of delivery 45 - 55 channels. The upgradation of the network has only taken place in metros with operators setting up HFC networks and 750/860 MHz networks. The number of channels shown in most cities ranges between 80 and 90 to between 60 and 70 in smaller towns. It varies from 25 to 45 in the rural areas depending on the capacity of the networks.

With the growth in market, technology is bound to evolve. Today, people are shifting from cable TV to their own satellite dishes. The cost of having a personal satellite dish has come down tremendously as compared to the mid-90's.

A personal dish provides better audio and video quality. It features 5.1 audio range as compared to the mono sound quality of cable TV. With HDTV no longer merely conceptual, this technological umbrella will only have wider and better video and sound quality. The current HDTV format is to have 7.1 Stereo channel and a video quality of 1080i x 780i, which is twice as better than your standard DVD.

HDTV or High Definition Television simply provides broadcast of television signal at a significantly higher resolution than the current formats of NTSC, SECAM or PAL. HDTV provides transmission that was only available on stored media. In eventuality, it will be even better than standard DVD.